Personalized Meal Plan

by Diabetes and Endocrinology Centre

Consolidated Meal Plan

Meal Plan

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks
Monday	Tofu jook with scallions and chili oil	Chinese mapo tofu (vegetarian, gluten-free) with steamed broccoli	Chinese eggplant with garlic sauce and pan-fried tofu	Edamame with chili flakes
Tuesday	Korean mung bean pancakes with kimchi	Korean bibimbap with mushrooms, spinach, carrots, tofu, and gochujang	Korean doenjang jjigae (soybean stew) with assorted vegetables	Roasted seaweed snacks
Wednesday	Filipino champorado with coconut milk and chia seeds	Filipino pinakbet (vegetable stew) with fried tofu	Filipino ginataang kalabasa (squash in coconut milk) with tofu	Crispy air-fried tofu bites with spicy dip
Thursday	Chinese steamed vegetable buns (gluten-free)	Vegetarian Chinese hot and sour soup with edamame	Spicy Chinese vegetable stir-fry with tempeh and peanuts	Sliced cucumber with chili-lime salt
Friday	Silken tofu with spicy soy-ginger sauce and cucumbers	Korean spicy cold tofu salad with sesame and cucumber	Korean spicy tofu stew (sundubu jjigae) with mushrooms	Korean-style pickled radish sticks
Saturday	Stir-fried bok choy and mushrooms with brown rice	Stir-fried snap peas and shiitake mushrooms with brown rice	Filipino vegetable lumpia with garlic vinegar dip	Mixed nuts with dried goji berries
Sunday	Korean seaweed soup with tofu and sesame seeds	Filipino laing (taro leaves in coconut milk) with grilled eggplant	Vegetarian Chinese Szechuan-style green beans with tofu	Filipino banana cue (air-fried, no added sugar)

Recipes

Low-Carb Tofu Jook with Scallions & Chili Oil (East Asian Style)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 190 kcal
Protein: 16g
Carbs: 8g
Fat: 11g

Ingredients

• 1 block (400g) firm tofu, drained and cubed (about 1.5 cm pieces)
• 1/2 cup (90g) cauliflower rice (fresh or frozen, thawed)
• 2 tbsp (20g) shelled edamame (optional, for extra protein)
• 4 cups (960ml) low-sodium vegetable broth (unsalted, or homemade)
• 2 tsp (4g) ginger, peeled and thinly sliced
• 2 cloves garlic, finely minced
• 1/4 tsp white pepper
• 2 scallions, thinly sliced (white and green parts separated)
• 1 tbsp neutral oil (e.g., avocado, canola, or grapeseed)
• 1 small dried red chili, crushed (or 1/2 tsp chili flakes, adjust to taste)
• 1/2 tsp toasted sesame oil
• 1 tbsp chopped cilantro (optional, for garnish)
• 1/2 tsp low-sodium gluten-free tamari OR coconut aminos (optional, for flavor boost)
• Lime wedges (optional, for serving)

Instructions

1. Prepare the tofu: Drain and gently press tofu to remove excess water. Cut into 1.5 cm cubes.
2. Set Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add neutral oil, ginger, garlic, and the white parts of the scallions. Sauté for 2 minutes until aromatic.

3. Add cauliflower rice and continue to sauté for 1 minute.
4. Pour in the low-sodium vegetable broth. Add the cubed tofu, edamame (if using), and white pepper. Stir gently.
5. Cancel 'Sauté' mode. Secure the lid and set Instant Pot to 'Pressure Cook' (High) for 2 minutes.
6. Once cooking is done, allow a natural release for 10 minutes, then carefully quick-release any remaining pressure.
7. Open the lid and gently stir. If you prefer a thicker jook, use a blender to puree 1 cup of the mixture, then stir back in.
8. Taste and adjust seasoning: Add low-sodium tamari or coconut aminos if desired. Stir in sesame oil.
9. For the chili oil: In a microwave-safe bowl, combine crushed dried chili and 1 tsp neutral oil. Microwave for 20-30 seconds until fragrant. (Alternatively, heat oil and chili in a small pan until bubbling; allow to cool slightly.)
10. Ladle jook into bowls. Drizzle with homemade chili oil. Garnish with scallion greens and cilantro. Serve with lime wedges if desired.

Korean Mung Bean Pancakes with Kimchi (Low Sodium, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free, Diabetic-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 110 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

• Dried mung beans (split, skinless) – 1 cup (190g)
• Water – for soaking and blending (about 2 cups, divided)
• Low-sodium kimchi (vegetarian, no fish sauce, well-rinsed) – 1/2 cup (80g), chopped
• Firm tofu – 1/2 block (about 150g), diced
• Carrot – 1 small (50g), julienned
• Zucchini – 1 small (80g), julienned
• Green onions – 2 stalks, sliced
• Garlic – 2 cloves, minced
• Gluten-free tamari (reduced sodium) – 2 teaspoons
• Sesame oil – 1 tablespoon
• Ground black pepper – 1/4 teaspoon

• Avocado oil spray or other neutral oil spray – for air fryer or pan

Instructions

1. Rinse mung beans thoroughly. Soak in plenty of water for at least 4 hours or overnight in the fridge.
2. After soaking, drain mung beans well and rinse again.
3. Add drained mung beans to a blender with 1/2 cup fresh water. Blend until you get a thick, mostly smooth batter (some texture is okay). If needed, add 1-2 tablespoons more water to blend.
4. In a large bowl, combine the mung bean batter, well-rinsed & chopped kimchi, diced tofu, carrot, zucchini, green onions, minced garlic, reduced sodium tamari, sesame oil, and black pepper. Mix well.
5. Taste batter and adjust seasoning if needed (avoid adding salt).
6. Line the air fryer basket or a parchment-lined tray with a light spray of avocado oil.
7. Scoop 1/4 cup of batter per pancake into the air fryer basket, flatten slightly to about 1/2-inch thick discs. Do not overcrowd.
8. Air fry at 375°F (190°C) for 10-12 minutes, flipping once halfway, until golden brown and crisp at the edges. Repeat with remaining batter.
9. Alternatively: Pan-fry on a nonstick skillet brushed lightly with oil, over medium heat, 3–4 minutes per side, until golden and cooked through.
10. Serve warm as is or with a dipping sauce made from reduced sodium tamari, vinegar, and a dash of sesame oil (optional – not included in nutrition).

Low-Carb Filipino Champorado with Coconut Milk & Chia Seeds

Nutritional Information

Calories: 175 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 22g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

• 1/2 cup black or forbidden rice (uncooked)
• 2 1/2 cups unsweetened light coconut milk (carton, not canned; or mix half canned coconut milk with water)
• 1 cup water
• 2 tablespoons chia seeds

• 2 tablespoons unsweetened cocoa powder (preferably alkalized/Dutch-processed for less bitterness)
• 1 1/2 tablespoons erythritol or monk fruit sweetener (adjust to taste; do not use sugar, honey, or syrups)
• 1/4 teaspoon kosher salt (optional, for flavor balance; omit if extremely sodium restricted)
• 2 tablespoons unflavored vegan protein powder (pea or soy isolate)
• 1 teaspoon vanilla extract (alcohol-free if desired)

Instructions

1. Rinse the black rice under cold water until the water runs mostly clear.
2. In the Instant Pot, combine the rinsed rice, 2 cups of the coconut milk, 1 cup water, and a pinch of salt (if using). Stir.
3. Seal the Instant Pot and cook on 'Porridge' or 'Manual' high pressure for 18 minutes. Allow natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then quick release.
4. While rice is cooking, whisk together cocoa powder, protein powder, and sweetener with the remaining 1/2 cup coconut milk in a small bowl until smooth.
5. Once rice is cooked and the lid is opened, set Instant Pot to 'Sauté' (low). Stir in the cocoa-protein-coconut milk mixture and chia seeds.
6. Simmer for 3-5 minutes, stirring constantly, until thickened to desired consistency. The chia seeds will help absorb liquid and give a creamy texture.
7. Turn off the heat, stir in vanilla extract, and let champorado sit for 5 minutes as it thickens further.
8. Spoon into bowls. Serve warm, optionally with a splash of extra coconut milk on top.

Chinese Steamed Gluten-Free Low-Carb Vegetable Buns (Diabetes-Friendly, Vegetarian)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 8g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

• 1 cup superfine almond flour
• 1/2 cup coconut flour

- 1/4 cup unflavored plant-based protein powder (pea or soy isolate, no added sugars or sodium)
- 2 tsp baking powder (gluten-free, sodium-free if possible)
- 1 tbsp psyllium husk powder
- 1 tbsp ground flaxseed
- 1 1/4 cup unsweetened, unflavored soy milk (or other high-protein plant milk)
- 1 tbsp olive oil (or neutral vegetable oil, optional)
- 1/2 cup firm tofu, crumbled
- 1/2 cup shiitake mushrooms, finely chopped
- 1/2 cup napa cabbage, finely shredded
- 1/4 cup carrot, finely grated
- 1/4 cup scallions, finely sliced
- 1 tbsp fresh ginger, minced
- 1 tbsp garlic, minced
- 1 tbsp low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative, or coconut aminos)
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 1 tbsp fresh cilantro, chopped (optional)
- 1/2 tsp ground white pepper

Instructions

1. Prepare the filling: In a non-stick skillet, heat 1 tsp olive oil (optional) over medium heat. Add ginger and garlic, sauté for 1 minute.
2. Add crumbled tofu, mushrooms, cabbage, carrots, scallions. Stir-fry for 3-4 minutes until vegetables soften.
3. Add low-sodium tamari, toasted sesame oil, white pepper, and cilantro (if using). Mix well. Remove from heat and let cool.
4. Prepare the dough: In a large mixing bowl, combine almond flour, coconut flour, protein powder, baking powder, psyllium husk, and flaxseed. Mix dry ingredients thoroughly.
5. Slowly add soy milk while mixing to form a soft, slightly sticky dough. Add olive oil if using.
6. Let the dough rest for 10 minutes to thicken (psyllium/flax will absorb liquid).
7. Divide dough into 8 equal portions. Using slightly damp hands, flatten each into a small disc (~4 inches diameter).
8. Spoon 1-2 tablespoons of filling into the center of each disc. Gather the edges and pinch to seal, forming a bun. Place seam-side down on a small square of parchment paper.
9. Place buns in Instant Pot trivet or steaming basket (on parchment), leaving space between. Add 1 cup water to the Instant Pot liner. Set to 'Steam' for 9 minutes (high pressure, vented).
10. Alternatively, use a stovetop steamer: Place buns on parchment in steamer over boiling water, cover, and steam for 12-15 minutes.
11. Let rest for 2 minutes after steaming before serving. Enjoy warm.

Silken Tofu with Spicy Soy-Ginger Sauce and Cucumbers (East Asian Style, Low Sodium, Low Carb, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 130 kcal
Protein: 11g
Carbs: 5g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

• Silken tofu (firm type preferred, refrigerated) – 300g (about 10.5 oz)
• English cucumber – 100g (about 1/3 large cucumber), thinly sliced
• Low sodium, gluten-free tamari – 1 tablespoon (15ml)
• Rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar/salt) – 1 tablespoon (15ml)
• Toasted sesame oil – 1 teaspoon (5ml)
• Fresh ginger, finely grated – 1 teaspoon (about 5g)
• Fresh garlic, finely minced – 1 small clove
• Sambal oelek (unsalted, no sugar added) OR Korean gochugaru (chili flakes) – 1/2 teaspoon (adjust to spice tolerance)
• Green onion (scallion), finely sliced – 1 tablespoon (about 5g)
• Toasted sesame seeds – 1/2 teaspoon
• Monk fruit or erythritol sweetener (optional) – 1/4 teaspoon
• Fresh cilantro or shiso (optional, for garnish) – 1 tablespoon, chopped

Instructions

1. Remove silken tofu from packaging, drain gently, and pat dry with a paper towel. Carefully transfer the tofu block onto a serving plate. If desired, cut tofu into thick slices for easier serving.
2. Slice the English cucumber thinly (with peel on) and arrange around or under the tofu.
3. In a small bowl, combine low sodium tamari, rice vinegar, toasted sesame oil, grated ginger, minced garlic, chili paste or flakes, and sweetener if using. Whisk to blend.
4. Taste the sauce and adjust to preference (add a splash more vinegar for tartness, or more chili for heat).
5. Spoon the sauce evenly over the tofu and cucumber.

6. Sprinkle with sliced green onion and toasted sesame seeds. Garnish with fresh cilantro or shiso if desired.
7. Serve immediately, chilled or at room temperature.

East Asian Stir-Fried Bok Choy & Mushrooms with High-Protein Brown Rice

Nutritional Information

Calories: 290 kcal
Protein: 12g
Carbs: 38g
Fat: 9g

Ingredients

• 1 cup cooked short-grain brown rice (cooled, for best glycemic control)
• 1 tbsp neutral oil (e.g., avocado or canola oil, for high heat)
• 2 cups baby bok choy, washed, stems separated if thick, leaves left whole
• 1.5 cups fresh shiitake mushrooms, stems removed, sliced (or use oyster or cremini mushrooms)
• 1/2 cup firm tofu, cubed (pressed and patted dry)
• 2 cloves garlic, finely minced
• 1 tsp fresh ginger, peeled and grated
• 2 scallions, sliced (whites and greens separated)
• 1 tbsp low-sodium gluten-free tamari (or coconut aminos for even lower sodium)
• 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
• 1/4 tsp ground white pepper
• 1/2 tsp rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar or salt)
• 1 tsp sesame seeds (optional, for garnish)
• 2 tbsp fresh cilantro or flat-leaf parsley, chopped (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. 1. Cook the brown rice in advance (using the Instant Pot, if desired), then cool completely for best glycemic control. Use 1 cup for this recipe.
2. 2. Prepare all ingredients: Slice mushrooms, cube tofu, mince garlic, grate ginger, and separate bok choy stems/leaves.

3. 3. Heat a large nonstick skillet or wok over medium-high heat. Add the neutral oil.
4. 4. Add tofu cubes and sear for 2–3 minutes until golden on most sides. Remove tofu and set aside.
5. 5. In the same pan, add garlic, ginger, and scallion whites. Stir-fry for 30 seconds until aromatic.
6. 6. Add mushrooms and bok choy stems. Stir-fry for 2–3 minutes until mushrooms start to soften.
7. 7. Add bok choy leaves and a splash of water (1–2 tbsp) to help steam. Stir-fry for 1–2 minutes until just wilted.
8. 8. Return tofu to the pan. Add low-sodium tamari, rice vinegar, and white pepper. Toss gently to combine.
9. 9. Drizzle with toasted sesame oil. Taste and adjust with more vinegar or white pepper if desired.
10. 10. Serve the stir-fry over 1 cup cooled brown rice. Garnish with scallion greens, sesame seeds, and fresh herbs if using.

Korean Seaweed Soup with Tofu & Sesame Seeds (Vegetarian, Low Sodium, Low Carb)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 110 kcal
Protein: 9g
Carbs: 5g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

• Dried wakame seaweed, 10g (about 1/2 cup dried)
• Firm tofu, 200g (about 7 oz), diced into 1 cm cubes
• Low-sodium vegetable broth, 1 liter (4 cups), unsalted
• Garlic, 2 cloves, minced
• Scallions, 2 stalks, sliced (green and white parts separated)
• Sesame oil, 2 teaspoons (use toasted sesame oil for flavor; optional, can omit or reduce for lower fat/cholesterol)
• White sesame seeds, 2 teaspoons, lightly toasted
• Low-sodium gluten-free tamari, 1 tablespoon (or coconut aminos for even lower sodium)
• Black pepper, 1/4 teaspoon
• Water, as needed for soaking seaweed

Instructions

1. Soak the dried wakame seaweed in a bowl of cold water for 10 minutes, or until fully rehydrated and expanded. Drain, squeeze out excess water, and set aside.
2. In the Instant Pot (or a pot on the stovetop), add the sesame oil and heat on 'Sauté' mode (or medium heat). Add the minced garlic and white part of scallions. Sauté for 1 minute until fragrant, but not browned.
3. Add the soaked, drained seaweed and sauté with garlic/scallion mixture for another 1-2 minutes. This helps infuse flavor.
4. Pour in the low-sodium vegetable broth. Stir well, scraping up any bits from the bottom.
5. Add the diced tofu. Secure the lid and set the Instant Pot to 'Soup' mode (or manual, 5 minutes, high pressure). If using stovetop, bring to a gentle simmer and cook for 10 minutes.
6. When done, quick-release pressure if using Instant Pot. Stir in tamari/coconut aminos and black pepper. Taste and adjust seasoning (avoid adding extra salt or soy sauce).
7. Ladle soup into bowls. Garnish with toasted sesame seeds and green part of scallions.
8. Serve hot.

Vegetarian Chinese Mapo Tofu with Steamed Broccoli (Low Sodium, Low Carb, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 240 kcal
Protein: 19g
Carbs: 14g
Fat: 12g

Ingredients

• 400g (14 oz) firm or medium-firm tofu, cut into 1-inch cubes
• 1 tablespoon cold-pressed canola oil or avocado oil
• 2 teaspoons toasted sesame oil (optional, for flavor)
• 3 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, minced
• 2 tablespoons low-sodium gluten-free tamari
• 1 tablespoon Chinese fermented black beans (douchi), rinsed and chopped (optional, omit for lowest sodium)
• 1 tablespoon Sichuan peppercorns, lightly crushed

• 1 tablespoon mild chili paste (such as gochujang or low-sodium doubanjiang) – ensure gluten-free & low sodium, or substitute 1 teaspoon chili flakes for even less sodium
• 1 cup low-sodium vegetable broth (homemade preferred, or use a low-sodium commercial version)
• 1 tablespoon cornstarch mixed with 2 tablespoons water (slurry)
• 2 green onions, sliced (white and green parts separated)
• 1 cup shiitake mushrooms, stemmed and chopped (fresh or rehydrated dried)
• 1 head (about 300g) broccoli, cut into florets
• Fresh cilantro or more sliced green onions for garnish (optional)

Instructions

1. Prepare the broccoli: Fill the Instant Pot with 1 cup water. Place a steamer basket with broccoli florets inside. Steam on 'Steam' setting for 0 minutes (it will cook during pressure build-up). Quick release and set broccoli aside, keeping warm.
2. Pat tofu dry with paper towels and cut into 1-inch cubes. Set aside.
3. Heat canola oil (and optional sesame oil) in a large nonstick skillet or wok over medium heat. Add garlic, ginger, and white parts of green onions; stir-fry for 1 minute until fragrant.
4. Add chopped mushrooms and stir-fry for 2-3 minutes until softened.
5. Add Sichuan peppercorns, chili paste (or flakes), and fermented black beans (if using). Stir-fry for 1-2 minutes.
6. Pour in low-sodium tamari and vegetable broth. Bring to a simmer.
7. Add tofu cubes gently to the sauce and simmer for 4-5 minutes, spooning sauce over tofu to coat. Do not stir vigorously to avoid breaking the tofu.
8. Stir cornstarch slurry, then gently add to the pan. Simmer until sauce thickens (1-2 minutes). Taste and adjust seasoning if needed (add more chili or green onion for flavor instead of salt).
9. Serve mapo tofu in bowls, topped with sliced green onion greens and fresh cilantro if desired. Plate with steamed broccoli on the side.

Korean Bibimbap with Mushrooms, Spinach, Carrots, Tofu, and Low-Sodium Gochujang (Vegetarian, Low-Carb, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 265 kcal
Protein: 19g
Carbs: 18g

Fat: 14g

Ingredients

• 200g extra-firm tofu, pressed and cubed
• 100g shiitake mushrooms, sliced (fresh or rehydrated dried)
• 120g fresh spinach (approx. 4 cups)
• 80g carrot, julienned (about 1 small carrot)
• 120g cauliflower rice (about 1.5 cups, fresh or frozen)
• 1 tbsp avocado oil (or other neutral, heart-healthy oil)
• 1 tsp sesame oil (optional, for flavor)
• 1 tbsp gluten-free low-sodium tamari (or coconut aminos)
• 1 tbsp rice vinegar
• 1 green onion, thinly sliced
• 1 tbsp toasted sesame seeds
• 1/2 tsp garlic, minced
• Fresh ground black pepper, to taste
• For Gochujang Sauce:
• 1 tbsp gluten-free gochujang paste (low-sodium, no added sugar if possible)
• 1 tbsp rice vinegar
• 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
• 1-2 tsp water (to thin as needed)
• 1/2 tsp monk fruit sweetener (or stevia, optional, to taste)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare the tofu: Pat tofu dry and cut into 1.5cm cubes. Toss with 1/2 tbsp avocado oil, 1/2 tbsp tamari, and black pepper. Air fry at 200°C (390°F) for 10-12 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and crisp. (Alternatively, pan-fry with minimal oil in a nonstick pan.)
2. 2. Prepare vegetables: While tofu cooks, microwave cauliflower rice for 2-3 minutes until tender. Set aside. Steam or microwave spinach for 1-2 minutes until wilted; squeeze out excess water, season with a few drops of sesame oil and black pepper.
3. 3. Sauté mushrooms: In a nonstick pan or Instant Pot (sauté mode), heat 1/2 tbsp avocado oil. Add garlic and mushrooms, sautéing until soft (4-5 minutes). Add 1/2 tbsp tamari and rice vinegar, toss well, and remove from heat.
4. 4. Prepare carrots: Microwave julienned carrots for 1 minute or lightly sauté in the same pan for 1 minute until crisp-tender.
5. 5. Make gochujang sauce: In a small bowl, whisk together gochujang, rice vinegar, sesame oil, water (as needed for consistency), and monk fruit sweetener. Taste and adjust sweetness or acidity as desired.

6. 6. Assemble bowls: Place a bed of cauliflower rice in each bowl. Arrange tofu, mushrooms, spinach, and carrots in sections on top. Drizzle with gochujang sauce. Garnish with green onion and toasted sesame seeds.
7. 7. Serve immediately. Mix together before eating for best flavor.

Pinakbet na Gulay with Air-Fried Tofu (Vegetarian, Low-Carb, Low-Sodium, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 210 kcal
Protein: 15g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 9g

Ingredients

• Firm tofu, 300g (pressed and cubed into 2 cm pieces)
• Olive oil, 1 tablespoon (for brushing tofu)
• Bitter melon (ampalaya), 1 small (about 80g), seeds removed, sliced into half-moons
• Eggplant (talong), 1 medium (about 120g), sliced into half-moons
• Okra, 8 pods (about 80g), ends trimmed, cut in half
• String beans (sitaw), 100g, cut into 5 cm pieces
• Kabocha squash (kalabasa), 100g, peeled and cubed
• Tomatoes, 2 medium (about 120g), diced
• Red onion, 1 small (about 50g), chopped
• Garlic, 3 cloves, minced
• Low-sodium tamari or coconut aminos, 1 tablespoon
• Vegetable broth (low-sodium, unsalted), 1/2 cup
• Ground black pepper, 1/4 teaspoon
• Optional: finger chili (siling haba), 1 piece, sliced (for flavor, not heat)
• Optional: 1 teaspoon sesame oil (for added flavor, use only if desired and within fat targets)
• Optional: 1/2 teaspoon stevia or monk fruit sweetener (to balance bitterness, if desired)

Instructions

1. Press the tofu for at least 15 minutes to remove excess water. Cut into 2 cm cubes.
2. Preheat the air fryer to 200°C (390°F). Toss tofu cubes with 1/2 tablespoon olive oil. Arrange in a single layer in the air fryer basket. Air fry for 12-15 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and crisp. Set aside.
3. While tofu cooks, heat remaining 1/2 tablespoon olive oil in a large nonstick skillet or Instant Pot (sauté mode) over medium heat.
4. Sauté onion until translucent (about 2 minutes), then add garlic and cook until fragrant (30 seconds).
5. Add diced tomatoes and cook until softened and juices release (2-3 minutes).
6. Stir in kabocha squash and vegetable broth. Simmer, covered, for 5 minutes.
7. Add eggplant, bitter melon, okra, and string beans. Stir gently.
8. Add tamari/coconut aminos, black pepper, and optional finger chili. Mix well. Cover and simmer for another 8-10 minutes, or until vegetables are just tender. Stir occasionally. If using sweetener, add now to balance bitterness.
9. Turn off heat. Gently fold in air-fried tofu and drizzle with optional sesame oil. Adjust seasoning with extra pepper or a squeeze of calamansi/lime if desired.
10. Serve warm, ideally without rice to keep carbs low. Enjoy!

Vegetarian Chinese Hot and Sour Soup with Edamame (Low Sodium, Low Carb, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 123 kcal
Protein: 11 g
Carbs: 12 g
Fat: 4 g

Ingredients

• 4 cups low-sodium vegetable broth (homemade or no-salt-added)
• 1 cup shelled edamame (frozen, thawed)
• 1 cup shiitake mushrooms, thinly sliced
• 1/2 cup firm tofu, cut into thin strips
• 1/2 cup bamboo shoots, julienned (no-salt-added, rinsed well)
• 1/2 cup napa cabbage, shredded
• 2 tablespoons rice vinegar (unseasoned, no sugar)

• 1 tablespoon coconut aminos (gluten-free, lower sodium alternative to soy sauce)
• 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, grated
• 2 garlic cloves, minced
• 1 tablespoon chili garlic sauce (low sodium; or use 1/2 teaspoon red chili flakes for less sodium)
• 1 tablespoon cornstarch (or arrowroot powder) mixed with 2 tablespoons cold water (for slurry)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil (optional, for flavor)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground white pepper
• 2 scallions, green parts only, thinly sliced (for garnish)
• Fresh cilantro, chopped (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. 1. In the Instant Pot (or stovetop pot), add the low-sodium vegetable broth, grated ginger, minced garlic, and sliced shiitake mushrooms. Set to 'Sauté' mode and cook for 3-4 minutes, stirring gently, until mushrooms begin to soften.
2. 2. Add bamboo shoots, napa cabbage, tofu strips, and edamame. Stir to combine.
3. 3. Pour in the rice vinegar and coconut aminos. Add chili garlic sauce or red chili flakes, and ground white pepper. Stir well.
4. 4. Lock the Instant Pot lid and set to 'Soup' or 'Manual' mode for 2 minutes. If using stovetop, bring to a gentle simmer and cook for 8 minutes.
5. 5. Carefully release pressure (if using Instant Pot). Stir the cornstarch or arrowroot slurry (1 tablespoon starch + 2 tablespoons cold water) into the soup. Set to 'Sauté' again and cook, stirring gently, until the soup thickens slightly (about 2-3 minutes).
6. 6. Turn off the heat. Drizzle in toasted sesame oil (if using) and stir.
7. 7. Ladle soup into bowls. Garnish with scallion greens and fresh cilantro, if desired. Serve hot.

Korean Spicy Cold Tofu Salad with Sesame and Cucumber (Low Sodium, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 182 kcal
Protein: 16g
Carbs: 8g
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

• 300g (about 10 oz) firm or extra-firm tofu (non-GMO, organic preferred)
• 1 medium cucumber (about 150g), thinly sliced
• 2 tablespoons Korean gochugaru (Korean red chili flakes, check for gluten-free and low sodium)
• 1 tablespoon toasted sesame oil
• 2 teaspoons low-sodium gluten-free tamari or coconut aminos
• 1 tablespoon rice vinegar (no added sugar, low sodium)
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame seeds
• 1 small garlic clove, minced
• 1 teaspoon fresh ginger, grated
• 2 green onions (scallions), thinly sliced
• 1/2 teaspoon monk fruit sweetener or erythritol (optional, for balance)
• 1/4 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
• Fresh cilantro or perilla leaves (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Drain the tofu and gently press between paper towels to remove excess water. Slice the tofu into 1.5cm (1/2 inch) thick pieces, then cut into bite-size cubes or rectangles.
2. Arrange the tofu cubes on a serving plate. Place in the fridge to chill while preparing other ingredients.
3. Wash and thinly slice the cucumber (leave skin on for fiber). Spread the cucumber slices around the tofu or mix with the tofu, depending on presentation preference.
4. In a small bowl, combine the gochugaru, sesame oil, low-sodium tamari (or coconut aminos), rice vinegar, minced garlic, grated ginger, monk fruit sweetener (if using), and black pepper. Stir well to create a smooth dressing.
5. Drizzle the spicy sesame dressing evenly over the tofu and cucumber.
6. Top with sliced green onions and toasted sesame seeds.
7. Garnish with fresh cilantro or perilla leaves if desired.
8. Serve immediately as a refreshing cold salad. Optionally, chill for 10-15 minutes in the fridge before serving to allow flavors to meld.

East Asian Stir-Fried Snap Peas and Shiitake Mushrooms with Brown Rice (Low Sodium, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 255 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 32g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

- 1 cup fresh snap peas, ends trimmed
- 1 cup fresh shiitake mushrooms, stems removed, caps sliced
- 1/2 cup firm tofu, pressed and diced (for extra protein)
- 2 teaspoons toasted sesame oil (divided)
- 2 cloves garlic, finely minced
- 1 inch ginger, finely minced
- 2 tablespoons low-sodium gluten-free tamari (or coconut aminos for even lower sodium)
- 1 tablespoon rice vinegar
- 1/2 teaspoon monk fruit sweetener or erythritol (optional, for balance)
- 1/2 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
- 1/4 teaspoon crushed red pepper flakes (optional)
- 2 tablespoons chopped green onion (for garnish)
- 1 tablespoon toasted sesame seeds (for garnish, optional)
- 1 cup cooked short-grain brown rice (preferably cooled, for best texture)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare all ingredients: Wash and trim snap peas. Slice shiitake mushroom caps. Press and dice tofu into 1/2-inch cubes.
2. 2. In a small bowl, mix the tamari (or coconut aminos), rice vinegar, monk fruit sweetener, and black pepper. Set aside.
3. 3. Heat 1 teaspoon sesame oil in a large nonstick skillet or wok over medium-high heat.
4. 4. Add tofu cubes and cook for 3-4 minutes, turning occasionally, until lightly golden on most sides. Remove and set aside.
5. 5. Add remaining 1 teaspoon sesame oil to the pan. Add minced garlic and ginger, stir-frying for about 30 seconds until fragrant.
6. 6. Add snap peas and shiitake mushrooms. Stir-fry for 2-3 minutes until snap peas are bright green and mushrooms are slightly softened.
7. 7. Return tofu to the pan. Pour in the prepared sauce, tossing everything together for 1-2 minutes until well coated and heated through. Taste and adjust seasoning if needed (avoid adding more salt).
8. 8. Warm the cooked brown rice in the microwave if needed. Portion 1/2 cup brown rice per serving onto plates.
9. 9. Spoon the stir-fried vegetables and tofu over the brown rice.
10. 10. Garnish with green onion and sesame seeds. Add a sprinkle of red pepper flakes if desired.

11. 11. Serve immediately.

Vegetarian Filipino Laing with Grilled Eggplant

Nutritional Information

Calories: 210 kcal
Protein: 9g
Carbs: 16g
Fat: 12g

Ingredients

• 200g dried taro leaves (soaked and rinsed well to remove oxalates)
• 2 cups light coconut milk (use low-fat, no salt added)
• 1/2 cup firm tofu, pressed and cut into small cubes
• 2 medium Japanese eggplants (about 300g total)
• 1 tablespoon olive oil (for grilling eggplant)
• 1 medium red onion, finely chopped
• 4 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 tablespoon ginger, finely chopped
• 2 long green chilies (siling pansigang), sliced (optional, for mild heat)
• 1/2 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
• 1 tablespoon coconut aminos (low-sodium, gluten-free alternative to soy sauce)
• 1 tablespoon nutritional yeast (for umami, optional)
• 1/2 cup water
• 1/4 cup chopped scallions (for garnish)
• Fresh calamansi or lime wedges (optional, for serving)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare taro leaves: Place dried taro leaves in a bowl of warm water for 10–15 minutes. Rinse thoroughly, drain, and squeeze gently to remove excess water. Set aside.

2. 2. Grill eggplant: Cut eggplants lengthwise in half. Brush with olive oil. Air fry at 200°C (392°F) for 12–15 minutes or until soft and slightly charred. Alternatively, grill in a pan or broil in the oven until tender. Set aside and keep warm.
3. 3. Sauté aromatics: Using the Instant Pot on 'Sauté' mode, add a splash of water (instead of oil) to sauté onions, garlic, and ginger until fragrant and translucent, about 2–3 minutes.
4. 4. Add tofu: Stir in tofu cubes and cook for another 2 minutes until lightly golden.
5. 5. Incorporate taro leaves: Add prepared taro leaves and green chilies, stirring gently.
6. 6. Add liquids: Pour in coconut milk, water, and coconut aminos. Mix well. Add black pepper and nutritional yeast.
7. 7. Simmer: Switch Instant Pot to 'Slow Cook' mode (or keep on 'Sauté' but at low heat). Cover and simmer for 20–30 minutes, stirring occasionally, until taro leaves are very soft and the mixture is thickened. Watch closely to prevent burning. Add a splash of water if needed.
8. 8. Taste and adjust: Adjust seasoning with more black pepper or calamansi/lime juice if desired (avoid adding salt).
9. 9. Serve: Arrange grilled eggplant halves on plates. Top generously with laing mixture. Garnish with chopped scallions and extra chilies if desired.

Chinese Eggplant with Garlic Sauce and Pan-Fried Tofu (Low Sodium, Low Carb, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 216 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 17g
Fat: 11g

Ingredients

• 2 medium Chinese eggplants (about 400g), cut into 1/2-inch thick half-moons
• 200g extra-firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1/2-inch cubes
• 1 tablespoon avocado oil (or canola oil)
• 3 tablespoons low-sodium gluten-free tamari (OR coconut aminos for even lower sodium)
• 2 tablespoons rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar or salt)
• 1 tablespoon water
• 1 tablespoon fresh ginger, finely minced
• 4 large garlic cloves, finely minced

• 1 tablespoon scallion (green part only), thinly sliced
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1/2 teaspoon chili flakes (optional, adjust to taste)
• 1 teaspoon arrowroot starch (or cornstarch, if tolerated)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground white pepper
• Nonstick spray (for pan or air fryer)

Instructions

1. 1. Tofu Preparation: Wrap the tofu block in a clean towel and press for 10–15 minutes to remove excess water. Cut into 1/2-inch cubes.
2. 2. Eggplant Preparation: Cut eggplants into 1/2-inch thick half-moons. Optionally, sprinkle lightly with salt and let sit 10 minutes to draw out bitterness, then rinse and pat dry. (For strict sodium restriction, skip this step.)
3. 3. Pan-Frying Tofu: Heat a large nonstick skillet or use an air fryer at 400°F (205°C). Lightly spray with nonstick spray. Add tofu cubes in a single layer. Cook on medium-high (or air fry) for 12–15 minutes, turning once, until golden and crisp. Remove and set aside.
4. 4. Sauté Aromatics: In the same pan, add avocado oil. Add minced garlic and ginger; sauté for 30–45 seconds until fragrant but not browned.
5. 5. Cook Eggplant: Add eggplant to the pan. Stir-fry 4–6 minutes until just softened and lightly browned. Add 1 tablespoon water if sticking.
6. 6. Sauce: In a bowl, mix tamari (or coconut aminos), rice vinegar, 1 tablespoon water, sesame oil, white pepper, and chili flakes (if using). In a separate small bowl, dissolve arrowroot starch in 1 tablespoon cold water.
7. 7. Combine: Return tofu to the pan with eggplant. Pour in sauce, stirring to coat. Add dissolved arrowroot mixture and stir constantly over medium heat until sauce thickens and glazes the vegetables and tofu (about 1–2 minutes).
8. 8. Finish: Remove from heat. Sprinkle with scallion greens. Serve hot.

Korean Doenjang Jjigae with Assorted Vegetables (Low Sodium, Vegetarian, Low Carb, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 155 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 12g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

• 2 cups water
• 1/2 cup low-sodium vegetable broth (unsalted, homemade or store-bought)
• 1/4 cup low-sodium doenjang (Korean fermented soybean paste, gluten-free if needed)
• 150g (5oz) firm tofu, cubed
• 1/2 small zucchini, sliced into half-moons (about 60g)
• 1/2 cup oyster mushrooms, torn into bite-size pieces
• 1/2 cup white radish/daikon, sliced thin (about 50g)
• 1/3 cup onion, sliced (about 40g)
• 1/4 cup carrot, sliced thin (about 25g)
• 1/2 cup napa cabbage, chopped (about 30g)
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 green chili or mild pepper, sliced (seeds removed for less heat)
• 1/2 cup baby spinach or Korean watercress
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
• 1/2 teaspoon ground black pepper
• 1 tablespoon chopped scallions (for garnish, optional)

Instructions

1. 1. In the Instant Pot (or a medium pot if stovetop), add water, low-sodium vegetable broth, onion, radish, carrot, and garlic. Use the sauté function and bring to a simmer (or medium-high heat on the stove).
2. 2. In a small bowl, dissolve the low-sodium doenjang in a few tablespoons of the hot broth from the pot, then stir back into the pot to prevent clumping.
3. 3. Add zucchini, mushrooms, napa cabbage, and chili pepper. Simmer for 5 minutes.
4. 4. Gently add tofu cubes and simmer another 4–5 minutes until vegetables are tender but not mushy.
5. 5. Stir in baby spinach (or watercress) and cook for 1 minute, just until wilted.
6. 6. Turn off heat. Drizzle sesame oil and sprinkle black pepper.
7. 7. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed, but avoid adding salt. Garnish with chopped scallions (optional).
8. 8. Serve hot, as a main dish or with a side of steamed cauliflower rice for a low-carb option.

Filipino Ginataang Kalabasa with Tofu (Low Carb, Vegetarian, Low Sodium)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 220 kcal
Protein: 15 g
Carbs: 15 g
Fat: 11 g

Ingredients

- 400g firm tofu (pressed and cut into 2 cm cubes)
- 2 cups (about 300g) kalabasa (Filipino squash or kabocha), peeled and cubed
- 1 cup (100g) sitaw (yardlong beans), cut into 2-inch pieces
- 1 tablespoon cold-pressed canola oil or light olive oil
- 1 small onion, minced (about 60g)
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 thumb-sized piece of ginger, peeled and sliced thinly
- 1 small red bell pepper, sliced (about 60g)
- 1 1/4 cups (300ml) lite/low-fat coconut milk (unsweetened)
- 1/2 cup (120ml) water
- 1 tablespoon low-sodium soy sauce (gluten-free tamari or coconut aminos, for gluten-free option)
- 1/2 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1/4 teaspoon turmeric powder (optional, for color and added anti-inflammatory benefit)
- 1/2 cup fresh spinach or malunggay leaves (optional, for added fiber and nutrients)
- 1 teaspoon calamansi or lemon juice (optional, for brightness)

Instructions

1. Pat tofu cubes dry. Air fry at 190°C (375°F) for 10-12 minutes or until golden, OR pan-sear in a nonstick pan with 1/2 tablespoon oil until lightly browned on all sides. Set aside.
2. Set Instant Pot to sauté mode (or use a nonstick pan if preferred). Add remaining 1/2 tablespoon oil. Sauté onion, garlic, and ginger until fragrant (about 2 minutes).
3. Add red bell pepper and kalabasa cubes. Continue stirring for 2-3 minutes.
4. Pour in the lite coconut milk and water. Stir in low-sodium soy sauce (or gluten-free alternative), black pepper, and turmeric if using. Mix well.
5. Add sitaw (yardlong beans). Cancel sauté mode and set Instant Pot to 'Pressure Cook' on LOW for 2 minutes (or simmer covered on stovetop for 6-8 minutes until vegetables are just tender).
6. Quick release pressure. Open lid and add air-fried tofu and spinach/malunggay leaves (if using). Stir gently and let residual heat wilt greens.
7. Taste and adjust seasoning if needed (use additional low-sodium soy sauce sparingly, or a squeeze of calamansi/lemon juice for brightness).

8. Serve hot as a main dish. Pairs well with cauliflower rice for a low-carb Filipino meal.

Spicy Chinese Vegetable Stir-Fry with Tempeh and Peanuts (Low Sodium, Low Carb, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 315 kcal
Protein: 20g
Carbs: 20g
Fat: 18g

Ingredients

• Tempeh, plain (organic, gluten-free) – 200g (about 7 oz), cut into 1/2-inch cubes
• Broccoli florets – 1 cup (90g)
• Red bell pepper – 1 medium (120g), sliced thinly
• Snow peas – 1/2 cup (50g), trimmed
• Shiitake mushrooms – 1/2 cup (40g), sliced
• Carrot – 1 small (60g), julienned
• Unsalted dry roasted peanuts – 2 tbsp (16g), roughly chopped
• Garlic – 2 cloves, minced
• Ginger – 1 tbsp, finely grated
• Green onion – 2 stalks, sliced (separate white and green parts)
• Neutral oil (e.g., canola, avocado, or light olive oil) – 1 tbsp
• Low sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce) – 1 tbsp
• Unseasoned rice vinegar – 2 tsp
• Toasted sesame oil – 1 tsp
• Chili garlic paste (low sodium, no added sugar) – 1 tsp (adjust to spice preference)
• Water – 2 tbsp
• Cornstarch (or arrowroot starch for GF) – 1 tsp
• Black pepper – 1/4 tsp
• Optional: Fresh cilantro or Thai basil for garnish

Instructions

1. In a small bowl, mix together tamari, rice vinegar, chili garlic paste, toasted sesame oil, water, and cornstarch. Stir well and set aside.
2. Heat a nonstick skillet or wok over medium-high heat. Add half of the oil. Add cubed tempeh and cook, stirring frequently, for about 3-4 minutes until golden brown on most sides. Remove tempeh to a plate.
3. Add the remaining oil to the pan. Add garlic, ginger, and white parts of the green onion. Stir-fry for 30 seconds until fragrant.
4. Add broccoli, carrots, bell pepper, snow peas, and mushrooms. Stir-fry for 3-4 minutes until just tender-crisp. If needed, add a splash of water to help steam the vegetables.
5. Return tempeh to the pan. Stir the sauce again and pour over the stir-fry. Toss well to coat and cook for 1-2 minutes until the sauce thickens and everything is heated through.
6. Sprinkle in black pepper and adjust spice to taste. Remove from heat.
7. Top with chopped peanuts and green onion tops. Garnish with cilantro or Thai basil if desired. Serve immediately.

Low-Sodium Korean Spicy Tofu & Mushroom Stew (Vegetarian Sundubu Jjigae)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 183 kcal
Protein: 15g
Carbs: 10g
Fat: 9g

Ingredients

• 300g (10.5 oz) extra-firm tofu, drained, cut into 2 cm cubes
• 200g (7 oz) fresh shiitake mushrooms, stems removed, sliced
• 100g (3.5 oz) enoki mushrooms, trimmed
• 1 small zucchini (about 100g), halved lengthwise and sliced
• 1/2 medium onion (about 50g), thinly sliced
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 tbsp ginger, grated
• 2 stalks green onion, chopped (separate white and green parts)

• 1 tbsp gochugaru (Korean red pepper flakes), no added salt
• 2 tsp low-sodium gluten-free tamari (or coconut aminos)
• 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
• 1 tsp neutral oil (like avocado or canola)
• 600 ml (2.5 cups) low-sodium vegetable broth (homemade or no-salt-added)
• 1 tsp rice vinegar
• 1/4 tsp black pepper
• Optional: 1/2 tsp monk fruit sweetener or erythritol (for balance, if desired)
• Optional: 40g (1.5 oz) baby spinach or bok choy, washed and chopped

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare all vegetables and tofu as described in the ingredients list.
2. 2. Set your Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add the neutral oil. When hot, add the white parts of the green onion, onion, garlic, and ginger. Sauté 2-3 minutes until aromatic.
3. 3. Add the gochugaru and sesame oil. Stir for 30 seconds to bloom the chili flakes, being careful not to burn.
4. 4. Add mushrooms and zucchini. Sauté for another 2-3 minutes.
5. 5. Pour in the low-sodium vegetable broth, tamari (or coconut aminos), rice vinegar, black pepper, and optional monk fruit sweetener. Stir well.
6. 6. Gently add tofu cubes and enoki mushrooms to the pot. (Add spinach or bok choy at this stage if using.)
7. 7. Cancel 'Sauté' mode. Close the Instant Pot lid, set valve to 'Sealing', and cook on 'Manual' (High Pressure) for 2 minutes.
8. 8. Carefully quick-release the pressure. Open the lid, taste, and adjust seasoning if necessary (add a dash more vinegar or tamari only if needed—keep sodium low).
9. 9. Serve hot, garnished with green onion tops. Enjoy as a stew or with a small side of steamed cauliflower rice for extra fiber (optional, not included in nutrition info).

Filipino Vegetable Lumpia (Low-Carb, Gluten-Free, Vegetarian) with Garlic Vinegar Dip

Nutritional Information

Calories: 75 kcal
Protein: 4g
Carbs: 10g

Fat: 2.5g

Ingredients

- 1 cup green beans, finely chopped
- 1 cup carrots, finely julienned
- 1 cup green cabbage, shredded
- 1/2 cup jicama (singkamas), finely julienned
- 1/2 cup firm tofu, crumbled
- 1/2 cup mung bean sprouts
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 tablespoons red onion, finely chopped
- 1 tablespoon avocado oil (or canola oil)
- 1 tablespoon coconut aminos (gluten-free, low-sodium alternative to soy sauce)
- 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 12 sheets gluten-free rice paper wrappers (8.5-inch, NOT wheat-based)
- Cooking spray (avocado or canola oil, for air fryer)

Instructions

1. Prepare all vegetables as indicated. Drain and press tofu well, then crumble.
2. Heat oil in a nonstick skillet over medium heat. Add garlic and onion, sauté until fragrant (about 1 minute).
3. Add carrots, green beans, and jicama. Stir-fry for 2-3 minutes until just softened.
4. Add shredded cabbage and crumbled tofu. Continue to stir-fry for another 2 minutes.
5. Add mung bean sprouts, coconut aminos, and pepper. Stir-fry for 1 minute until everything is just cooked. Remove from heat. Let mixture cool slightly.
6. Fill a shallow dish with warm water. Dip one rice paper sheet for 10 seconds until just pliable. Lay on a clean, damp cloth.
7. Place 2-3 tablespoons of the cooled vegetable filling along the lower third of the wrapper. Fold sides over, then roll up tightly to seal. Repeat with remaining wrappers and filling.
8. Preheat air fryer to 380°F (193°C). Lightly spray lumpia with oil spray.
9. Place lumpia in air fryer basket in a single layer (work in batches if necessary). Air fry 7–9 minutes, turning halfway, until wrappers are crisp and lightly golden.
10. Serve hot with garlic vinegar dip.

Vegetarian Szechuan-Style Green Beans with Tofu (Low Sodium, Low Carb, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 195 kcal
Protein: 14g
Carbs: 12g
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

- 300g (10 oz) fresh green beans, trimmed
- 200g (7 oz) extra-firm tofu, pressed and cut into 1/2-inch cubes
- 1 tbsp avocado oil or canola oil (divided)
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 inch (10g) fresh ginger, minced
- 1 small red chili, thinly sliced (or 1/2 tsp crushed red pepper, optional for spice)
- 1 tbsp reduced-sodium tamari (gluten-free, low sodium soy sauce alternative)
- 2 tsp rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar/salt)
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 1/2 tsp Szechuan peppercorns, crushed (optional for authentic flavor, use less for milder spice)
- 2 tbsp water
- 1 tsp arrowroot or cornstarch (gluten-free), mixed with 1 tbsp water (slurry)
- 2 stalks scallions, green parts only, thinly sliced
- 1/4 cup fresh cilantro leaves, chopped (optional)
- Nonstick spray (for air fryer, if using)

Instructions

1. Prepare tofu: Pat tofu dry with paper towels. Cut into 1/2-inch cubes. For extra crispiness, air fry tofu cubes at 375°F (190°C) for 12 minutes, shaking halfway, using a light spritz of nonstick spray. Alternatively, pan-fry in a nonstick skillet with 1/2 tbsp oil until golden on all sides. Set aside.
2. Blanch green beans: Bring a pot of water to a boil (or use Instant Pot on sauté with water). Add green beans and cook for 2 minutes until bright green and just tender. Drain and rinse immediately under cold water to stop cooking. Pat dry.
3. Make sauce: In a small bowl, whisk together reduced-sodium tamari, rice vinegar, sesame oil, 2 tbsp water, and arrowroot slurry.

4. Sauté aromatics: In a large nonstick skillet or wok, heat remaining 1/2 tbsp oil over medium-high. Add ginger, garlic, Szechuan peppercorns, and red chili. Stir-fry for 1 minute until fragrant.
5. Add green beans and tofu: Toss in the blanched green beans and cooked tofu. Stir-fry for 2-3 minutes, letting the beans blister slightly (for authentic flavor).
6. Add sauce: Pour in the sauce, stirring to coat everything evenly. Stir-fry for another 1-2 minutes until sauce thickens and coats the beans and tofu.
7. Finish: Remove from heat. Top with sliced scallions and cilantro if desired. Serve hot.

Spicy Edamame with Korean Chili Flakes (Gochugaru)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 180 kcal
Protein: 16g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

• 2 cups frozen, unshelled edamame (about 300g)
• 1 tsp toasted sesame oil (cold-pressed if available)
• 1/2 tsp Korean chili flakes (gochugaru) or Chinese chili flakes
• 1/2 tsp low-sodium soy sauce substitute (e.g., coconut aminos, optional, see tips)
• 1 clove garlic, finely minced
• 1/2 tsp toasted sesame seeds (optional, for garnish)
• 1 green onion, finely sliced (green part only, for garnish)

Instructions

1. 1. Place the frozen edamame in a steaming basket or on a microwave-safe plate.
2. 2. Steam edamame over boiling water for 5-6 minutes, or microwave in a covered bowl with 2 tbsp water for 3-4 minutes, until bright green and tender. Drain well.
3. 3. While still hot, toss edamame with sesame oil and minced garlic in a large bowl, mixing thoroughly.

4. 4. Sprinkle in the Korean chili flakes and (if using) the low-sodium soy sauce substitute. Toss again to coat evenly.
5. 5. Transfer to a serving bowl. Garnish with sliced green onions and sesame seeds (if using). Serve warm or at room temperature.

Korean-Style Low Sodium Roasted Seaweed Snacks (Vegetarian, Low Carb, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 49 kcal
Protein: 4.3g
Carbs: 2.9g
Fat: 3.2g

Ingredients

• 10 full sheets gim/nori (Korean or Japanese roasted seaweed, unsalted, plain)
• 2 teaspoons toasted sesame oil (cold-pressed, sodium-free)
• 1 tablespoon roasted white sesame seeds
• 1/8 teaspoon potassium-based salt substitute (optional and only if approved by healthcare provider, otherwise omit)
• 1/4 teaspoon nutritional yeast (for a cheesy, umami flavor and extra protein, optional)
• Cooking spray (neutral oil, e.g., avocado oil, optional for extra crispiness)

Instructions

1. Preheat the air fryer to 300°F (150°C) for 3 minutes.
2. Lay a sheet of nori shiny side down on a clean, dry surface. Using a pastry brush or the back of a spoon, lightly brush one side with a thin layer of toasted sesame oil.
3. Sprinkle a pinch of roasted sesame seeds and a tiny amount of nutritional yeast (if using) evenly over the oiled surface.
4. Stack another nori sheet on top, gently pressing to adhere, and repeat until you have 5 pairs of sheets (total 10 sheets).
5. Using kitchen scissors, cut each stacked pair into strips or squares (about 2 inches wide).
6. Lightly spray the air fryer basket with cooking spray or line with parchment paper suitable for air fryers.
7. Place the nori pieces in a single layer in the basket (work in batches if needed to avoid overlap).
8. Air fry at 300°F (150°C) for 3–4 minutes, checking halfway through—seaweed should turn crispy but not burnt. Remove promptly.
9. Let cool completely. The snacks will continue to crisp as they cool. Store in an airtight container to preserve crispness.

Crispy Air-Fried Tofu Bites with Spicy Gochujang-Lime Dip (East Asian Style)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 165 kcal
Protein: 15g
Carbs: 9g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• Firm tofu (organic, low sodium if available) – 400g (1 block)
• Cornstarch – 2 tbsp
• Toasted sesame oil – 1.5 tsp
• Garlic powder – 1/2 tsp
• Black pepper – 1/4 tsp
• Spring onion (green part only), finely sliced – 2 tbsp
• Fresh cilantro, finely chopped – 1 tbsp (optional)
• Low sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative) – 1 tsp
• Gochujang (Korean chili paste, low sodium, gluten-free version) – 1 tbsp
• Fresh lime juice – 1 tbsp
• Rice vinegar – 1 tsp
• Erythritol or monk fruit sweetener – 1/2 tsp
• Water – 2 tbsp
• Sesame seeds (to garnish) – 1/2 tsp

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare tofu: Drain and press the tofu for at least 20 minutes to remove excess water. Cut into 2 cm cubes.
2. 2. In a large bowl, gently toss tofu cubes with sesame oil, garlic powder, black pepper, and cornstarch until evenly coated.
3. 3. Preheat air fryer to 200°C (390°F) for 2 minutes.
4. 4. Arrange tofu cubes in a single layer in the air fryer basket. Do not overcrowd; cook in batches if needed.

5. 5. Air fry tofu for 12–15 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and crispy. Remove and set aside.
6. 6. For the dip: In a small bowl, whisk together gochujang, lime juice, rice vinegar, erythritol/monk fruit sweetener, water, and tamari until smooth.
7. 7. Sprinkle tofu bites with sliced spring onion and cilantro (if using), and sesame seeds.
8. 8. Serve immediately with the spicy gochujang-lime dip on the side.

East Asian-Style Sliced Cucumber with Chili-Lime Salt

Nutritional Information

Calories: 55 kcal
Protein: 2g
Carbs: 9g
Fat: 2g

Ingredients

• 1 large English cucumber (about 300g), washed and ends trimmed
• 1/2 teaspoon salt-free chili powder (use Korean gochugaru or Chinese chili flakes, no added salt)
• 1/2 teaspoon lime zest (from 1 fresh lime, unwaxed)
• 1 tablespoon fresh lime juice
• 1 teaspoon toasted sesame seeds
• 1/2 teaspoon low-sodium soy sauce (gluten-free, optional, Tamari recommended; can omit for even lower sodium)
• 1 tablespoon chopped fresh cilantro (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Slice the cucumber thinly (about 1/8 inch thick) on a diagonal for greater surface area. Place slices in a mixing bowl.
2. In a small bowl, combine the salt-free chili powder (gochugaru or Chinese chili flakes), lime zest, and toasted sesame seeds.
3. Drizzle the fresh lime juice and, if using, the low-sodium gluten-free soy sauce over the cucumber slices. Toss gently to coat.
4. Sprinkle the chili-lime-sesame mixture evenly over the cucumbers. Toss again to distribute the spices.
5. Transfer to a serving plate. Garnish with chopped fresh cilantro if desired.
6. Serve immediately for crisp texture, or chill in the fridge for 10–15 minutes for a refreshing, cold snack.

Korean-Style Low-Sodium Pickled Radish Sticks (Musaengchae-Inspired, Diabetic-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 30 kcal
Protein: 1g
Carbs: 6g
Fat: 0.5g

Ingredients

• Daikon radish – 400g (about 1 medium)
• Rice vinegar (unsweetened, gluten-free) – 80ml (1/3 cup)
• Water – 80ml (1/3 cup)
• Erythritol or monk fruit sweetener – 2 tbsp (granulated, zero-calorie, diabetic-safe)
• Low-sodium tamari (gluten-free soy sauce alternative) – 1 tsp
• Garlic – 1 small clove, finely minced
• Korean gochugaru (mild chili flakes, optional for flavor & color) – 1/2 tsp
• Toasted sesame seeds – 1 tsp
• Green onion – 1, thinly sliced

Instructions

1. Peel the daikon radish and cut into sticks approximately 1cm x 1cm x 5cm (like thick matchsticks).
2. Place radish sticks in a colander and rinse briefly under cold water. Shake off excess water and set aside.
3. In a mixing bowl, combine rice vinegar, water, erythritol (or monk fruit sweetener), and low-sodium tamari. Stir until the sweetener is dissolved.
4. Add minced garlic and gochugaru (if using) to the pickling liquid. Stir to combine.
5. Place the radish sticks in a clean glass container or food-grade plastic container.
6. Pour the pickling liquid over the radish. Ensure all pieces are submerged (press gently if needed).
7. Cover and refrigerate for at least 4 hours, preferably overnight, to allow flavors to develop.
8. Before serving, gently toss the pickled radish with sliced green onion and sprinkle with toasted sesame seeds.

East Asian-Style Mixed Nuts with Dried Goji Berries

Nutritional Information

Calories: 210 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 11g (net carbs ~8g, due to fiber)
Fat: 15g

Ingredients

• Unsalted raw almonds – 30g (about 20 nuts)
• Unsalted raw cashews – 20g (about 12 nuts)
• Unsalted raw walnuts – 20g (about 7 halves)
• Unsalted raw pumpkin seeds (pepitas) – 10g (about 1 tbsp)
• Dried goji berries (unsweetened) – 10g (about 1 tbsp)
• Toasted black sesame seeds – 1 tsp
• Roasted unsalted edamame (shelled) – 20g (about 2 tbsp)
• Roasted nori seaweed (plain, no added salt or oil) – 1 sheet, cut into small strips
• Low-sodium soy sauce alternative (coconut aminos or homemade low-sodium soy sauce) – 1 tsp (optional, for a light East Asian flavor)
• Toasted sesame oil – 1/4 tsp (optional, for aroma, omit if ultra-low fat is required)

Instructions

1. In a large bowl, combine almonds, cashews, walnuts, pumpkin seeds, goji berries, black sesame seeds, and roasted edamame.
2. If using, very lightly drizzle with low-sodium soy sauce alternative and toasted sesame oil. Toss well to coat. (Optional for added East Asian flavor; skip for strictest sodium control.)
3. Spread the mixture on a plate and microwave on medium power for 1 minute to lightly warm and blend flavors (optional). Alternatively, use the air fryer at 140°C (285°F) for 2 minutes for a gentle toast, watching closely to avoid burning.
4. Allow the mixture to cool slightly. Add nori strips and toss gently.
5. Portion into small serving bowls or containers. Store leftovers in an airtight container in the fridge.

Diabetes-Friendly Filipino Banana Cue (Air Fryer, Low Sugar, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 2g
Carbs: 23g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

- 2 medium saba bananas (or plantains, underripe/just ripe)
- 1 tbsp coconut oil, melted
- 1 tbsp golden monk fruit sweetener (or erythritol, granular, for caramel effect; low glycemic alternative to sugar)
- 1/4 tsp ground cinnamon (optional, for flavor and blood sugar support)
- 1 tbsp roasted unsalted crushed peanuts (optional, for protein and crunch)

Instructions

1. 1. Peel the saba bananas and slice each banana in half lengthwise or keep whole, as preferred.
2. 2. In a small bowl, mix the monk fruit sweetener and cinnamon (if using).
3. 3. Brush the bananas lightly with melted coconut oil on all sides.
4. 4. Sprinkle and gently press the monk fruit mixture onto the bananas to coat evenly.
5. 5. Preheat your air fryer to 375°F (190°C) for 3 minutes.
6. 6. Arrange the coated bananas in a single layer in the air fryer basket.
7. 7. Air fry for 8–10 minutes, turning halfway through, until the bananas are golden, caramelized, and slightly crisp on the edges.
8. 8. Remove from the air fryer. If desired, sprinkle with roasted crushed peanuts for added protein and texture.
9. 9. Serve warm. Portion is 1 banana per serving.

Shopping List

Plant-Based Protein

- Firm tofu / extra-firm tofu / silken tofu - 3.5 kg
- Tempeh - 200 g

Dairy Alternatives

- Lite or unsweetened coconut milk (carton or can) - 2.5 l
- Unsweetened, unflavored soy milk (or other high-protein plant milk) - 1.5 l

Canned/Bottled & Pantry

- Low-sodium vegetable broth (unsalted or homemade) - 6 l
- Bamboo shoots (no-salt-added, canned or fresh) - 1 can

Condiments & Sauces

- Coconut aminos (low-sodium gluten-free soy sauce alternative) - 250 ml
- Low-sodium gluten-free tamari - 500 ml
- Gochujang (Korean chili paste, low sodium, gluten-free) - 100 g
- Doenjang (Korean fermented soybean paste, low sodium, gluten-free) - 100 g
- Rice vinegar (unseasoned, no added sugar/salt) - 600 ml
- Toasted sesame oil - 200 ml

- Avocado oil / canola oil / neutral oil / olive oil - 400 ml
- Cooking spray (avocado or canola) - 1 can
- Apple cider vinegar or cane vinegar - 250 ml

Spices & Seasonings

- Ground black pepper - 1 small jar
- White pepper (ground) - 1 small jar
- Sichuan peppercorns - 1 small jar
- Chili flakes (gochugaru, red chili flakes, or Chinese chili flakes) - 50 g
- Salt-free chili powder - 1 small jar
- Turmeric powder - 1 small jar
- Kosher salt - 1 small box

Baking & Sweeteners

- Erythritol or monk fruit sweetener (granular, zero-calorie) - 200 g
- Vanilla extract - 1 small bottle
- Cornstarch or arrowroot starch - 200 g
- Psyllium husk powder - 100 g
- Ground flaxseed - 100 g
- Baking powder (gluten-free, sodium-free if possible) - 1 small tin
- Unflavored plant-based protein powder (pea or soy isolate) - 200 g
- Unflavored vegan protein powder (pea or soy isolate) - 100 g
- Superfine almond flour - 200 g
- Coconut flour - 100 g
- Chia seeds - 100 g
- Toasted sesame seeds (white & black) - 100 g
- Nutritional yeast - 50 g
- Baking powder (gluten-free, sodium-free) - 1 small tin
- Monk fruit sweetener (golden, for caramel effect) - 50 g

Grains & Rice

- Short-grain brown rice (uncooked) - 1 kg
- Black or forbidden rice (uncooked) - 200 g

Dry Beans & Lentils

- Dried mung beans (split, skinless) - 200 g

Frozen & Refrigerated

- Shelled edamame (frozen or fresh) - 500 g

Asian Grocery & Seaweed

- Dried wakame seaweed - 50 g
- Nori/gim seaweed sheets (unsalted, plain) - 12 sheets
- Dried taro leaves - 200 g
- Rice paper wrappers (gluten-free, 8.5 inch) - 1 pack (12 sheets)

Produce

- Napa cabbage - 1 head (≈2 lb)
- Green cabbage - 1 head (≈2 lb)
- Carrots - 3 lb
- Cauliflower (whole or riced, fresh or frozen) - 2 heads (≈3 lb total) or 1 × 1 kg bag cauliflower rice
- Baby bok choy - 2 lb
- Spinach (fresh or baby, bagged) - 1 × 454 g bag
- Malunggay leaves (moringa) or extra spinach - 1 × 250 g bag
- Kabocha squash (kalabasa) / Filipino squash - 2 pieces (≈600 g each)
- Eggplant (Chinese or Japanese) - 5 pieces (≈400 g each)
- Okra - 1 lb
- String beans (yardlong beans/sitaw) - 1 lb
- Bitter melon (ampalaya) - 2 pieces (≈100 g each)
- Red bell pepper - 3 pieces
- Green onion / scallion - 4 bunches
- Red onion - 2 lb
- Yellow/brown onion - 1 lb
- Daikon radish - 2 pieces (≈400 g each)
- White radish/daikon - 1 piece (≈400 g)
- Jicama (singkamas) - 1 piece (≈250 g)
- Carrot (extra for garnish or matchsticks) - 1 lb
- Zucchini - 3 pieces (≈150 g each)
- Baby spinach / watercress (for garnish/stew) - 1 × 250 g bag
- Japanese eggplant - 2 pieces (≈150 g each)
- Tomatoes - 2 lb
- Green beans - 1 lb
- Green chili / finger chili / mild chili - 0.25 lb
- Bird’s eye chili - 2 pieces
- Long green chilies (siling pansigang) - 2 pieces
- Fresh cilantro / coriander - 2 bunches
- Flat-leaf parsley or shiso or Thai basil (for garnish) - 1 bunch
- Fresh ginger - 1 lb
- Fresh garlic bulbs - 6 bulbs
- Lime - 6 pieces
- Saba banana or plantain - 2 pieces
- English cucumber - 3 pieces (≈300 g each)
- Cucumber (regular, for salads) - 2 pieces (≈250-300 g each)
- Snap peas - 1 lb
- Snow peas - 0.5 lb

- Baby bok choy or spinach (extra for garnish) - 1 × 250 g bag
- Shiitake mushrooms (fresh or dried, see note) - 1 kg
- Oyster mushrooms - 0.5 lb
- Enoki mushrooms - 100 g
- Mung bean sprouts - 1 × 250 g bag
- Saba bananas or plantains - 2 pieces
- Spring onion (green part only) - 1 bunch
- Calamansi or lemon - 2 pieces

Dried Fruit & Nuts

- Goji berries (unsweetened, dried) - 50 g
- Unsalted raw almonds - 100 g
- Unsalted raw cashews - 100 g
- Unsalted raw walnuts - 100 g
- Unsalted raw pumpkin seeds (pepitas) - 100 g
- Roasted unsalted edamame (shelled) - 100 g
- Unsalted dry roasted peanuts - 100 g